

with the advent of PCI-Express, you could chuck all this out the window and go for a complete platform change a la 486DX4-to-Pentium II upgrades in the '90s.

The motherboards for both Pentium IV and AMD Athlon or Duron look alike with the exception of the processor socket types. They have the same PCI slots, USB ports, IDE/SATA connectors and regular ATX power connectors. Thus, illustrating an upgrade for a Pentium IV motherboard will give you a fair idea of how to go about installing an AMD motherboard. This process is, again, the same for PCI-Express motherboards for both processors, except for the processor installation process. This has been discussed earlier. We will therefore talk about upgrading from a Pentium II motherboard to a Pentium IV motherboard.

1. Check the computer case size. If you have an older AT case with an AT power supply, you will need to upgrade to a newer case with a newer PIV-compatible power supply (at least 350 to 400 W). PCI-Express motherboards come with a new type of ATX connector that requires a different type of ATX power supply that is exclusive to these motherboards. You will need to clearly and specifically mention the motherboard type to the hardware dealer to buy the right power supply.
2. Similar to the CPU upgrade process, open the case and clear all obstructions and dust. Then, unscrew and remove all cards installed on the motherboard. Remove all power cables and IDE connectors that are attached to the board. If the IDE drives and power supply are obstructing the removal of the motherboard from the case, carefully unscrew the screws attached on the sides and remove the IDE drives from the cabinet. As explained earlier, remove the power supply from the cabinet.
3. Now, take a look at the motherboard. You will see that there are screws attaching the motherboard to the cabinet. At some places, there may be plastic studs on which the motherboard may be mounted. Carefully remove the screws and then